

AccessWay - Project Brief

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AccessWay is an Android application designed to help people with reduced mobility and other accessibility needs to plan their visits to public places and tourist attractions. The application allows users to discover places on an interactive map and access practical information about their accessibility.

Problem statement

People with reduced mobility find travel difficult, because there is little reliable information about how accessible hotels, transport and tourist attractions really are. Existing information is often generic, outdated or missing, so users cannot tell in advance whether an entrance is step-free, an elevator exists or a route is usable.

Social Good Goal

- To help people with reduced mobility and other accessibility needs to plan visits independently and with confidence
- Make practical, first hand accessibility knowledge easy to find and share
- Encourage venue owners to publish accurate accessibility information

User Stories

- **Wheelchair user -** I want to know where elevators and step-free entrances are located
  in shopping malls so that I can plan my visit and move around independently.
- **Bussiness owner** - I want to share information about the accessibility of my restaurant, inclujding ramps and accessible entrances, so that people with reduced mobility can plan their visits.
- **Blind traveler** - I want to access information about accessible routes to tourist attractions so that I can plan my journey safely and independently

Existing Solutions

- **Google Maps** has accessibility options, however it only gives a generic short list (e.g. parking, seating, entrance, toilets) without expaining what each means. It has no detailed user-contributed accessibility content or voting on how trustworthy it is.
- **Wheelmap** focuses only on wheelchair users, has no mobile app and uses a general classification of places. This makes broad rating easy but gives little detail.

Assumptions

- Detailed first-hand information is more useful than a general accessibl

Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

An Android mobile application that helps people with reduced mobility find and evaluate accessible places. The app will display an interactive map where users can search for places using the Google Maps Platform and add accessibility information to specific locations using map pins.

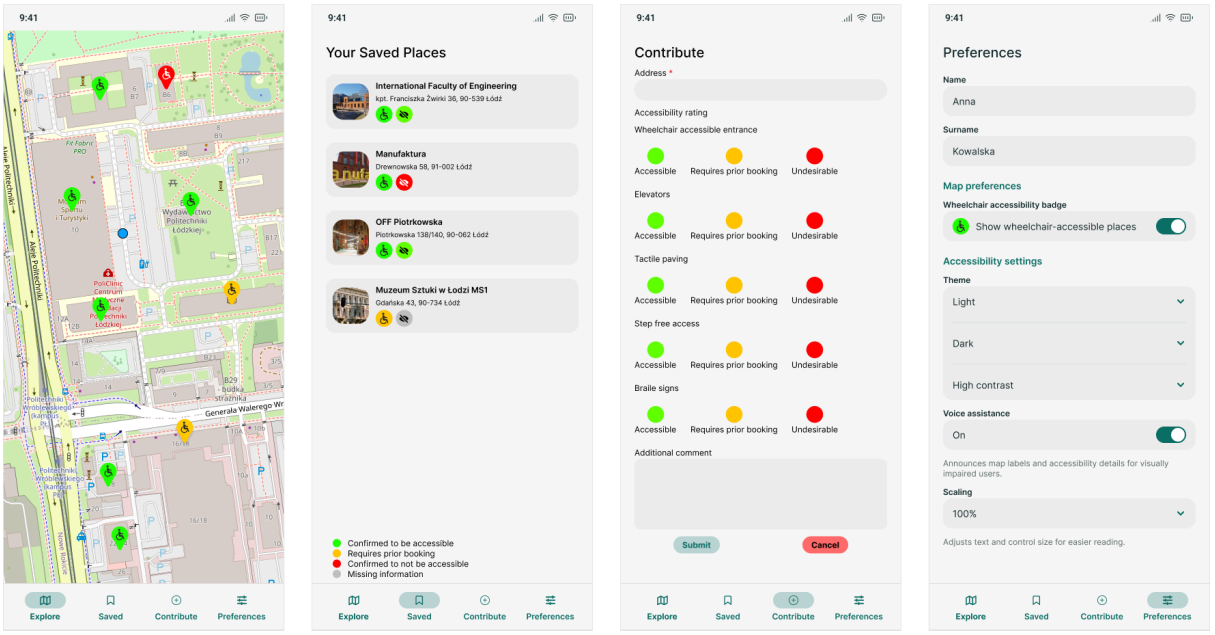
Each place will display its name, address, Google Maps rating (where available), and user-contributed information about accessibility features, including entrance accessibility and available facilities.

Users will be able to select accessibility categories, such as:

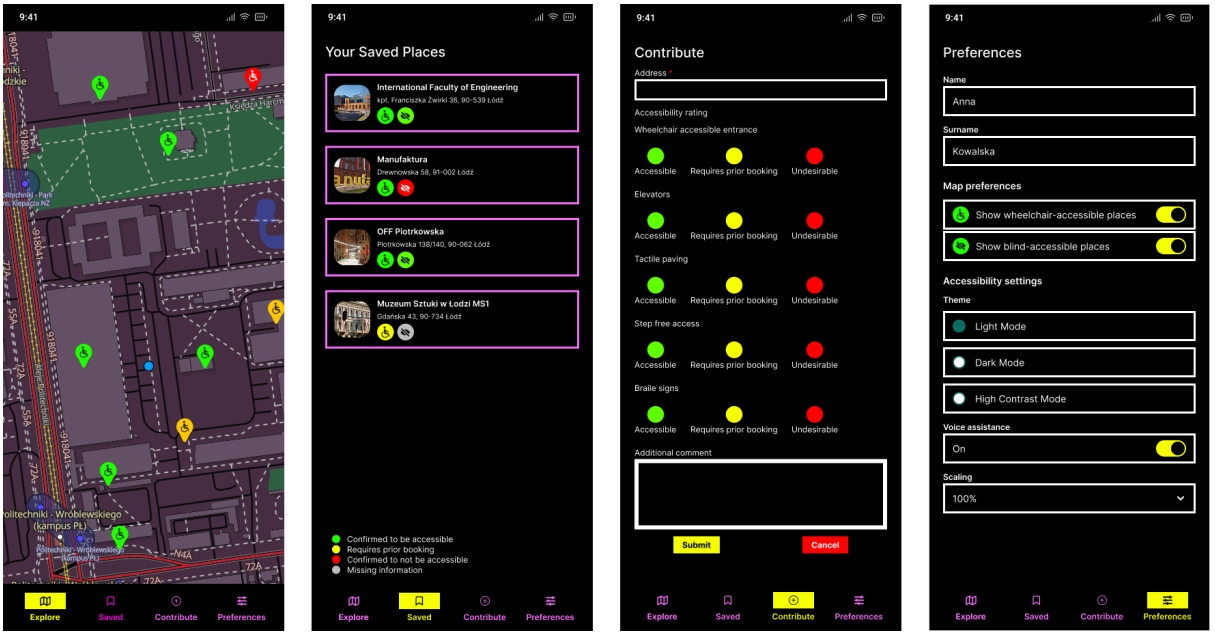
- Wheelchair-accessible entrance
- Elevators
- Ramps
- Tactile paving for visually impaired users
- Step-free access

The MVP does not include route planning with accessiblity-aware navigation, venue owner verification and platforms other than Android.

Prototype



Light Mode



High Contrast Mode

Accessibility

- **Enlarged text support** - text size setting with default, large and XL options
- **Appearance modes** - light mode, dark mode and high contrast mode
- **TalkBalk support** - the native Android Text-To-Speech accessibility option